

Communication Skills for Agriculturalists

Science

May, 2026

Communication Skills for Agriculturalists (A07382)

Short Title: Comm. Skills Ag.
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster IT
Author MCAHILL
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will teach the student how to communicate effectively both in a written and oral context. Library skills and the sourcing of information will be taught. The referencing of sources, footnotes, bibliography, styles and plagiarism will be also be covered. Students will be taught presentation skills and will make a presentation on a topic of their choice.

Programmes

COMM-0075 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

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Indicative Content

- Planning and structuring a piece of written communication: parts of speech, rules of grammar, rules of punctuation
- Proof-reading skills, editing skills, reading and interpreting articles
- Writing a report: structure, development, delivery
- Communication in teams: stages in team-building (forming, storming, norming, performing); composition of successful teams; SMART thinking; group cohesiveness/group thinking
- Leadership: structure of formal meeting; role of secretary; role of chairperson, function of agenda, minutes, standing orders, motions
- Making a presentation: identifying the audience, defining objectives, research, rehearsal; structuring a presentation
- Finding and locating information, evaluating the quality, referencing sources, footnotes, bibliography, referencing styles, plagiarism

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Identify information from reliable sources and reference material correctly.
2. Reproduce letters, reports, minutes and memoranda.
3. Report information orally and communicate information using audio-visual aids.
4. Demonstrate the structures of a formal meeting, e.g. role of secretary, role of chairperson, function of agenda, minutes, standing orders, motions.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical demonstrations and practice in computer lab.
- Videos.
- Group work.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Portfolio	80%	1,2,4
Presentation	20%	3

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** No presentation and/or no portfolio. Students must do both the presentation and the portfolio to pass.
- 40%-49%:** Presentation adequate, portfolio with 50% of material to an acceptable standard. Student can proofread a passage and write a business letter.
- 50%-59%:** Presentation good with clear ideas and logical structure. Portfolio complete with proofreading, letters, minutes, short report all good.
- 60%-69%:** Presentation logical and persuasive. Portfolio complete with proofing, reports, minutes and letter.
- 70%-100%:** Presentation with clear ideas and logical structure. Portfolio complete with proofreading, letters, minutes good, reports with appropriate references.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	12	
Practical	24	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- McClave, H. _Communications for Business_. 4th ed. Dublin: Gill & McMillan Ltd, 2008.

Requested Resources

- Room Type: Computer Lab